Metformin

Helps lower your blood sugar



What does it do?

- Reduces the amount of sugar made by your liver.
- Helps your body use insulin better.
- Works best with a healthy diet and regular physical activity.



How should I take it?

- Take with or after food to reduce stomach upset.
- Take it at the same time every day.
- Take it exactly as prescribed by your doctor.
- If you use an extended-release tablet, swallow it whole (do not crush or chew).
- Do not stop the medicine on your own.



Common side effects

- Nausea
- Diarrhoea
- Stomach discomfort
- Abdominal pain
- Loss of appetite
- Metallic taste

These stomach-related effects are often more noticeable when treatment is started and may improve with continued use.



Symptoms of low blood sugar (hypoglycemia)

You may feel:

- Shakiness
- Sweating
- Dizziness
- Hunger
- Weakness
- Confusion
- Irritability
- Difficulty in concentrating



15-15 Rule for Low Blood Sugar

If you feel symptoms of low blood sugar (such as shakiness, sweating, dizziness, hunger or confusion):



1. **Take 15 grams of fast-acting sugar** (e.g., 3–4 glucose tablets, ½ cup fruit juice or 1 tablespoon sugar/honey).



2. **Wait 15 minutes** and check your blood sugar again (if possible).



3. **If still low,** repeat the 15 grams of sugar and wait another 15 minutes.

Once it is above 70 mg/dL, have a small snack or meal to prevent it from dropping again.

Seek medical attention immediately if you develop:

Unusual severe weakness, difficulty breathing, unusual sleepiness, dizziness or persistent stomach symptoms (possible signs of lactic acidosis – a rare but serious complication).





Do not stop metformin without consulting your doctor or pharmacist.